KEIZERSGRACHT MEDIA • DESIGN SYSTEM

# Technical Schematic Visual Language

VERSION 1.0
SPECIFICATION GUIDE

Design standards, spatial parameters, and UI abstractions for creating editorial software architecture diagrams and case study illustrations.

## 1 Core Philosophy: The “Living Blueprint”

Illustrations in the Keizersgracht Media visual universe are **never** generic SaaS doodles, clip art, or glossy 3D renders. They represent an **abstracted architectural blueprint of software**:

- **Tangible & Honest:** Visually communicate the exact logic of modern software—inputs, data states, validation gates, and human review steps.
- **Minimalist UI Abstraction:** Interface states are suggested via skeleton bars, floating cards, status chips, and data tokens—never literal full-screen browser chrome or low-res app screenshots.
- **Warm Editorial Craft:** Grounded in warm paper tones, technical hairline strokes, and tactile micro-chamfers rather than synthetic cold tech gradients.

## 2 The 3-Act Narrative Structure

Every diagram must tell an immediate visual story flowing **from left to right**:

ACT 1: ENTRY

**Raw Input**

Unstructured data, customer requests, floor plans, sensor streams.

→

ACT 2: STUDIO CRAFT

**Rules & Processing**

AI complexity analysis, logic engine, verified database validation.

→

ACT 3: OUTCOME

**Tangible Output**

Fixed project price (€), instant human-approved draft, verified sanitation score.

## 3 Spatial System & Canvas Dimensions

All illustrations adhere to a responsive mathematical coordinate grid:

DESKTOP MASTER CANVAS

`960px × 480px` (strict 2:1 aspect ratio). Encapsulated in `<ScaledCanvas width={960} height={480}>` for seamless vector downscaling on tablets and laptops.

MOBILE STACKING LOGIC

On viewports below `768px`, horizontal flows automatically stack vertically, transitioning connectors to downward paths ( `<DownArrow />` ).

- **Breathing Margins:** Maintain at least `48px` interior padding from canvas boundaries.
- **Node Spacing:** Spacing between primary nodes is fixed between `32px` and `48px` horizontally.

# Color System & Geometric Specifications



## 4 Color Palette & Semantic Roles

Colors carry functional meaning. Never apply colors decoratively outside their established roles:

| TOKEN | HEX CODE | SEMANTIC ROLE IN ILLUSTRATIONS |
|---|---|---|
| **Canvas** | `#F5F4ED` | Primary fill for cards, nested panes, and tactile background blocks. |
| **Sand** | `#ECECDC` | Secondary container fill, container border strokes, inactive UI nodes. |
| **Espresso** | `#351E1C` | Primary typography, high-contrast headline data bars, and structural icons. |
| **Terracotta** | `#733635` | Secondary notes, technical captions, logic rules, and connector labels. |
| **Coral** | `#FF6037` | **The Action Accent:** Ready states, active step pill, approved draft badges. Strict limit: 1–2 spots per illustration. |
| **Aqua** | `#A0C9CB` | **The Machine / AI State:** Algorithmic parsing chips, AI analysis highlights, clean water/data pipeline states. |

## 5 Geometry & The Architectural Chamfer

To avoid generic modern SaaS roundness ("AI slop"), corners use precise micro-radii:

### Container Chamfer `rounded-[3px]`

Outer cards, floating windows, and major diagram panes use **3px** radius. Clean, structural, and tactile.

**Tag: rounded-[2px]** **Action: rounded-[2px]**

### Line Weights & Elevation

- **Card Borders:** `1.5px solid #ECECDC` (Sand stroke).
- **Step Dividers:** `1px border-t border-border-subtle/55`.
- **Warm Shadow:** `shadow-card` ( `0 10px 24px rgba(115, 54, 53, 0.08)` ). Faint terracotta tint lifts cards off background.

**Chamfer Micro-Rules:**

- Outer cards & panes: `rounded-[3px]` | Inner chips & status badges: `rounded-[2px]` | Skeleton bars: `rounded-[1px]`.
- *Never use circular pills ( `rounded-full` ) or large radii ( `12px+` ).*

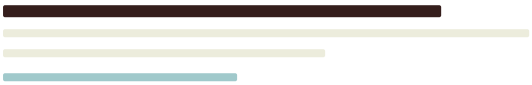
# UI Primitives, Typography & Production Rules



## 6 UI Skeleton Primitives & Abstract Components

Rather than rendering realistic text fields, use abstract UI building blocks:

### DATA SKELETON BARS (<Bar />)



6px Espresso (Title) • 4px Sand (Body) • 4px Aqua (AI state)

### STATUS BADGES (<Badge />)




Semibold Poppins, uppercase, tracking-wider, micro-chamfer 2px.

## 7 Typography Hierarchy inside Diagrams

| HIERARCHY ROLE | FONT & SIZE | COLOR | USAGE EXAMPLE |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Top Headline / Claim** | `Sintony` 17px (bold) | Espresso ( `#351E1C` ) | "Drawings in. Price out." |
| **Step Node Titles** | `Sintony` 13px–14px (bold) | Espresso ( `#351E1C` ) | "AI Complexity Analysis" |
| **Technical Captions** | `Poppins` 11px–12px | Terracotta / Taupe | "Fixed rules • Almost immediately" |
| **Micro-Tags / Chips** | `Poppins` 10px–11px (semi) | Terracotta ( `#733635` ) | "★ RECORD" / "● COMPLETED" |

## 8 Do's and Don'ts Production Checklist

### ✓ DO

- **Keep generous whitespace:** Let the blueprint breathe with wide internal margins.
- **3-Second Clarity:** A viewer should understand input and output in under 3 seconds.
- **Strict Coral Discipline:** Reserve coral exclusively for final action / outcome.
- **Architectural Chamfers:** Always use `rounded-[2px]` or `rounded-[3px]`.

### ✗ DON'T

- **No 3D or Isometric Art:** Avoid bubbly cartoon characters or 3D plastic cubes.
- **No Neon Gradients:** Never introduce purple, bright indigo, or generic AI gradients.
- **No Full Browser Dumps:** Do not paste full screenshots; abstract the essential data.
- **No Rounded-Full Pills:** Steer clear of circular lozenges (16px+ radius).